

DevNexus | AgileBridge

USER MANUAL

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 agilebridge
CONSIDERED
SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS

1.Introduction

1.1 Welcome to UniTrade

UniTrade is a peer-to-peer marketplace platform built for South African university students to buy and sell items such as textbooks, study materials and other students essentials. The platform verifies student identity before granting full access, uses AI-assisted risk scoring to screen listings before they go live and manages the entire transaction lifecycle, from browsing and reservation, through in-person meetups, to secure payment and handover confirmation. Payments are processed via Payfast and PIN-based system confirms that a handover has taken place. A reputation and dispute-handling system supports trust between users.

1.2 Document Purpose

This user manual explains how to effectively use UniTrade, from creating and verifying an account, through listing, browsing, reserving and buying items, to completing a meetup and resolving disputes if something goes wrong. It is intended to help users understand each step of the process, what to expect at each stage, and what actions are available to them, so they can use the platform confidently and safely.

1.3 Who can Use UniTrade

- Registered students at South African universities with a valid university email domain.
- Both buyers and sellers, every user can act in either role
- Students at any stage of the verification process, with access levels that differ depending on verification status:
 - Unverified/pending users: buyers can browse listings only (no chat or purchase), sellers can create listings, but they're saved as drafts and stay invisible to others.
 - Verified users: full access to browsing, chatting, reserving, listing and buying.
- Admin staff, who are internal reviewers assigned per university, responsible for handling flagged verifications, listings, and disputes.

Key Features

- **Student verification** – Sign-up with university email domain checking, OTP verification, and proof-of-registration upload, backed by an AI scanning layer with admin fallback for uncertain cases.
- **AI-assisted listing moderation** – Listings are automatically risk-scored (reserve-image checks, content classification) and routed to go live or held for admin review.
- **Marketplace browse** – View listings with title, price, condition, category and photos, reserve and add to your wishlist directly from the product card.
- **Reservations** – Express interest in an item to trigger an automated message and a time-boxed reservation, with clear acknowledgement and response windows.
- **In-app chat** – Coordinate directly with the other party to arrange meetup time and location through a meetup scheduler.
- **Secure payment** – Pay instantly via Payfast after inspecting the item in person.
- **PIN-based handover confirmation** – A PIN generated after payment confirms the item actually changed hands.
- **Ratings and reputation** – Rate the other party after a transaction, reputation scores factor into trust and abuse detection.
- **Dispute reporting** – flag listing-quality issues, no-shows, or false listing claims for admin review.
- **Recommendations** – Behaviour-driven suggestions like “Popular for course code” or “Frequently bought together”, based on real student activity rather than a fixed material list.

2. User Roles and Responsibilities

UniTrade has three primary roles. Most students will act as both a buyer and a seller depending on the transaction, while admins are internal staff supporting the platform.

2.1 Buyer

Responsibilities:

- Complete registration and identity verification before gaining full buying access.
- Browse listings and use “Reserve” to initiate a reservation.
- Respond and schedule a meeting within the 24-hour window, to keep the reservation active.
- Communicate with the seller in-app chat to arrange a meetup time and location.
- Physically inspect item at the meetup **before** paying.
- Pay via Payfast only once satisfied with the item.
- Enter into the PIN exchange process by receiving the PIN after payment and showing it to the seller to confirm handover.
- Take photos at the meetup if a listing does not match its description, to support any quality complaint.
- Rate the seller and item after transaction.
- Report listings that appear false, misleading or incorrect.

Access limits while unverified: Can view listings only, cannot chat, reserve or purchase.

2.2 Seller

Responsibilities:

- Complete registration and identity verification before listings can go live.
- Create accurate listings, including title, description, price, condition, and course/module tags and upload clear, honest photos.
- Acknowledge a buyer’s reservation.
- Coordinate meetup time and location with the buyer.
- Bring the correct item, matching the listing, to the meetup.
- Allow the buyer to photograph the item at the meetup if requested.
- Enter the buyer’s PIN after payment to confirm and close the handover.
- Respond to admin for changes if a listing is flagged (e.g. reupload clearer photos or a correct description)

Access limits while unverified: Can create listings, but they remain in draft status and are invisible to buyers until the seller is verified.

3.3 Admin

Responsibilities:

- Review flagged student verifications and approve or reject access within the ~2-3 days SLA.
- Review listings flagged as medium-for-review or high risk by the AI scoring system and approve, reject or request changes.
- Investigate reported listings for false or misleading claims.
- Review listing-quality complaints after a failed meetup and apply strikes where appropriate.
- Monitor patterns of repeated no-shows and apply reputation consequences once the threshold is crossed.
- Oversee flagged listing images surfaced through the moderation queue.
- Notify users of decisions via in-app and email notifications.

3. System Requirements

Requirements

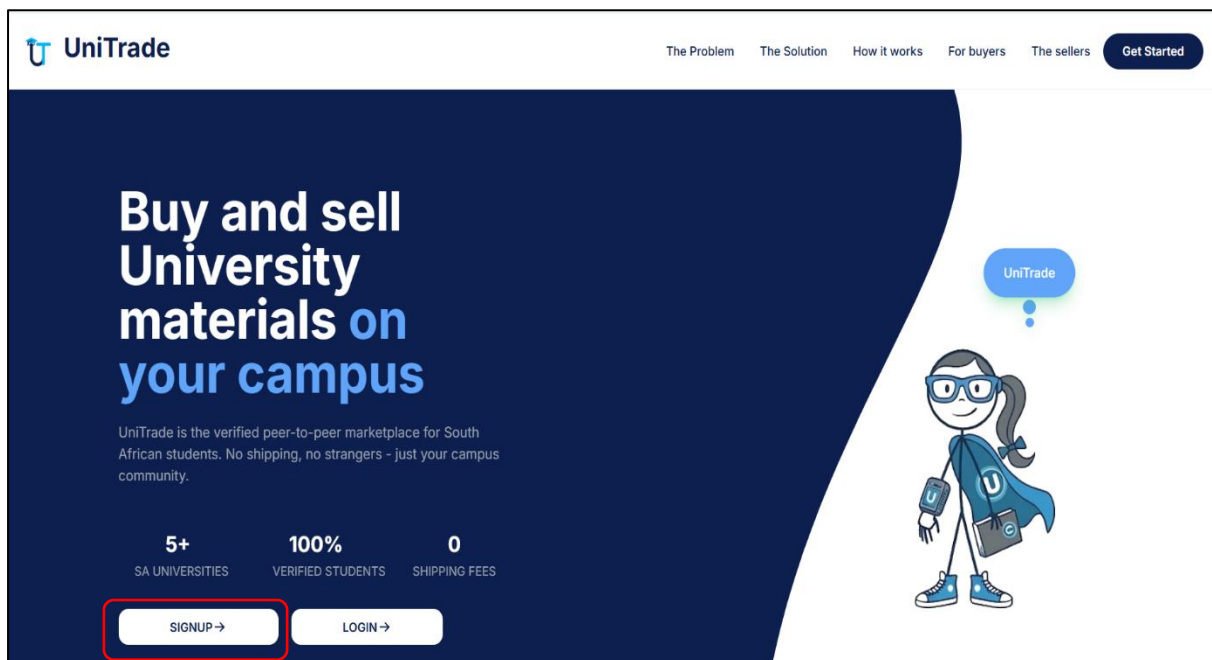
- **Device:** Any smartphone, tablet or a computer capable of running a modern web browser and connecting to the internet.
- **Operating system:** No specific OS required, UniTrade runs in the browser and works across Windows, macOS, Linux, Android and iOS
- **Browser:** A modern, up-to-date browser with PWA support is recommended for the best experience, such as:
 - Google Chrome (recommended for full PWA support on Android/desktop)
 - Safari (for iOS/macOS – required for “Add to Home Screen” on iPhone/iPad)
 - Microsoft Edge
 - Firefox
- **Account requirements:** A valid student email address at a supported South African university, used during registration and OTP verification.
- **Permissions needed:**
 - Camera or file access, to upload proof of registration and listing photos.
 - Notifications access, for meetup reminders, chat messages, and status updates.
- **Connectivity:** A stable internet is required throughout – for verification, AI listing checks, real-time chat, and payment processing. UniTrade is not designed as an offline-first app, so most features need an active connection.
- **Payment:** A Payfast supported payment method to complete purchases at the meetup.

4. Account Management

Creating an Account

If you are a new user:

1. Navigate to Registration
 - Open your preferred web browser.
 - Go to the UniTrade website.
 - Click “Sign Up” on the home page.

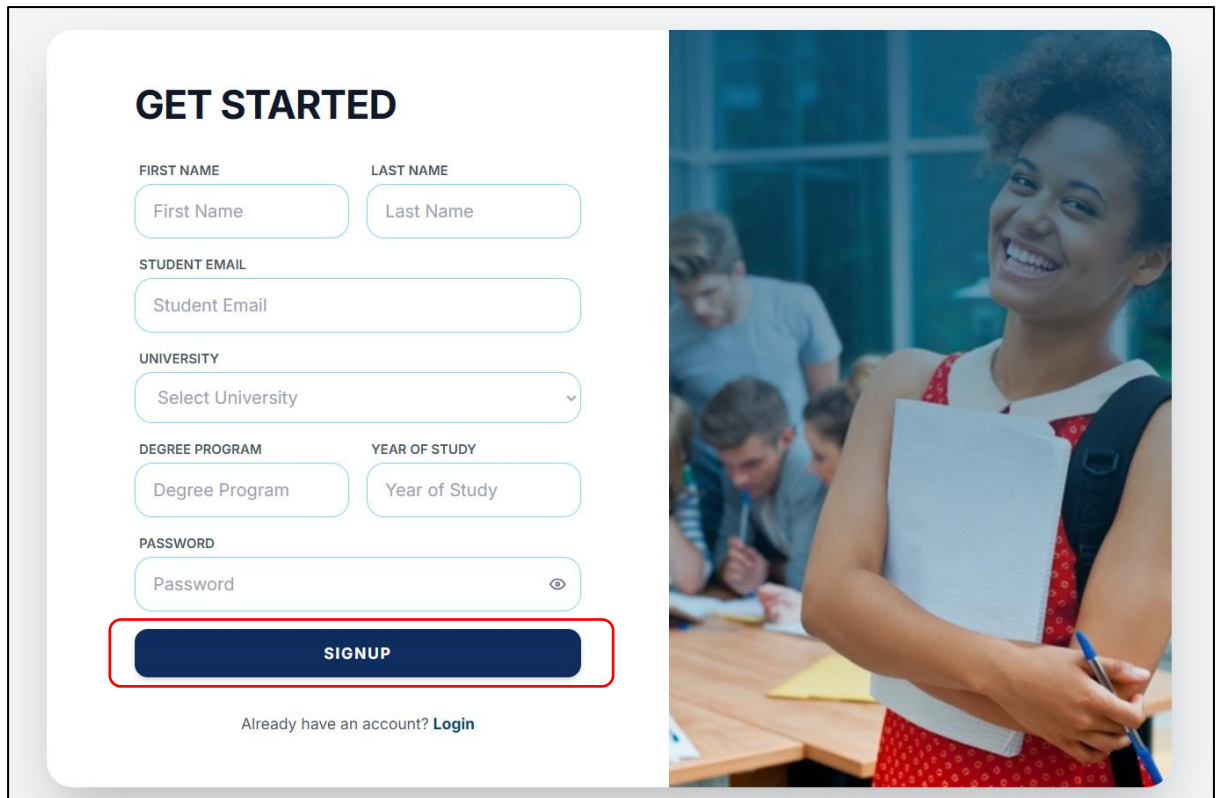


2. Complete the Registration form: Fill in all the required information truthfully:

- First Name
 - Enter your legal first name as it appears on your university records.
 - This will be used to identify you correctly during transactions.
- Last Name
 - Enter your legal surname as it appears on your university records.
 - This will be used for the same verification and identification purposes.
- Email
 - Enter your official student email address (e.g. ending in your university's domain, such as @tuks.co.za).
 - This must be a valid, currently active South African university email.
 - This address is where you will receive your OTP verification code and important account updates, so make sure you have access to it always.
- University
 - Select your university from the provided list.
 - This will be used to match you with the correct student community, ensure listings and recommendations are relevant to your campus.
- Degree Program
 - Enter the degree you are currently enrolled in (e.g. BSc Computer Science).
 - This helps us tailor course-related listing recommendations to your field of study;
- Year of Study
 - Select your current year of study.
 - Like your degree program, this helps the system surface more relevant listings and recommendations.
- Password
 - Create a secure password to protect your account.
 - Minimum length – 8 characters
 - A mix of uppercase, lowercase, numbers and symbols
 - Avoid reusing passwords from other sites
 - Your password is never visible to admins or other users.
 - Use the eye icon to make sure you created the correct password.

3. Submit the Form

- Click “Sign Up”
- If your registration was successful, you will be taken to the OTP Verification page.



The image shows a registration form titled "GET STARTED" on the left and a background image of a smiling student on the right. The form fields are as follows:

- FIRST NAME**: Input field with placeholder "First Name".
- LAST NAME**: Input field with placeholder "Last Name".
- STUDENT EMAIL**: Input field with placeholder "Student Email".
- UNIVERSITY**: Dropdown menu with placeholder "Select University".
- DEGREE PROGRAM**: Input field with placeholder "Degree Program".
- YEAR OF STUDY**: Input field with placeholder "Year of Study".
- PASSWORD**: Input field with placeholder "Password" and an eye icon for toggling visibility.
- SIGNUP**: A dark blue button with white text, highlighted by a red border.
- Already have an account? [Login](#)**: A link to the login page.

4. Enter the OTP and verify

- Enter the OTP sent to your student email in the six available slots
- Click “Verify”
- Once successfully verified your account will be activated and ready for use.

Logging Into the System

Once your account is created and verified you will be taken to the login page to login into the system:

1. Enter your Credentials.

- Email: enter your registered student email address
- Password: Enter your password (use the eye icon to check for any typing errors)

2. Submit Login

- Click the “Login” button.
- After a successful login you will be taken to your buyer’s dashboard

WELCOME BACK!

Enter your credentials to access your account

EMAIL ADDRESS

PASSWORD



LOGIN

Don't have an account? [Sign Up](#)



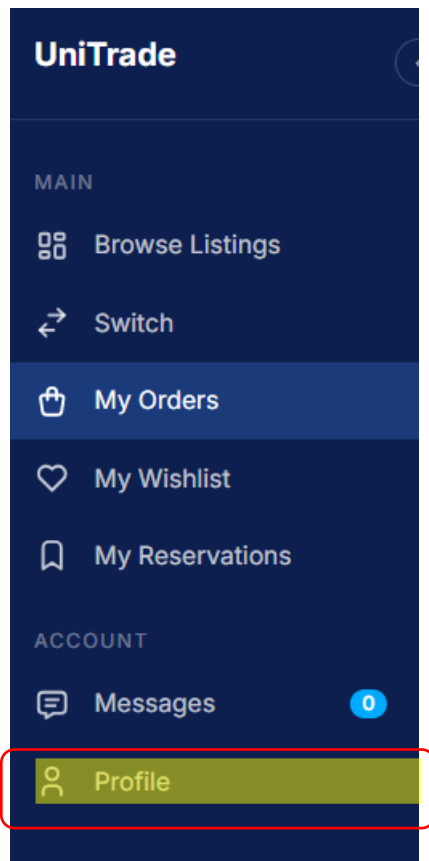
Profile Management

Accessing your profile

Once logged in, you can access your profile/account setting by using the profile tab on the side bar. You can access this tab from both the seller's side or the buyer's side.

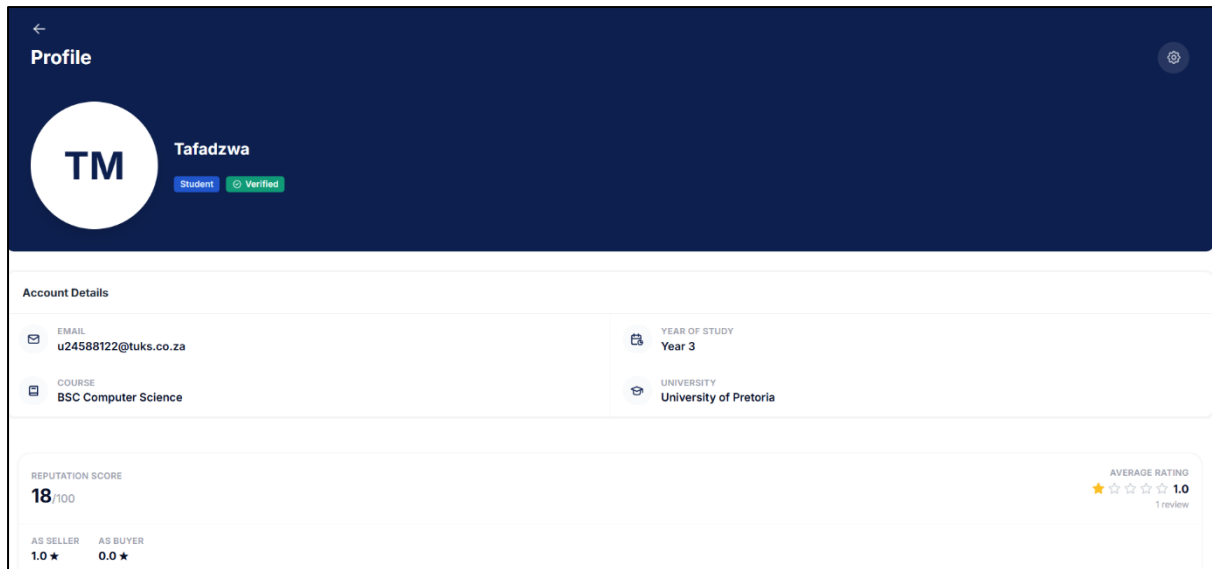
1. Navigate to Profile

- Click "Profile" on the side bar to access your profile page.



2. Profile Overview The details available on your profile page:

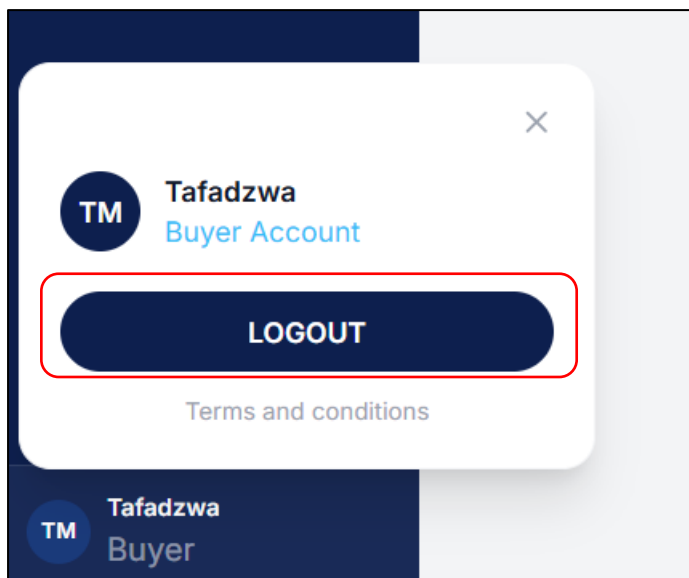
- Your full name
- Your role (either student or admin)
- Account details
 - Your student email address
 - Year of study
 - Your Course
 - University
- Reputation score (out of 100)
- Average Rating
- Your reviews



Logging Out

When you are done using the system you can safely logout:

1. Use the logout button from the profile page:
 - Click “Logout” to successfully end your session.
2. Use the logout button from the navbar:
 - Click on your account information at the bottom of the navbar.
 - Click “Logout” on the pop up that appears to end your session.

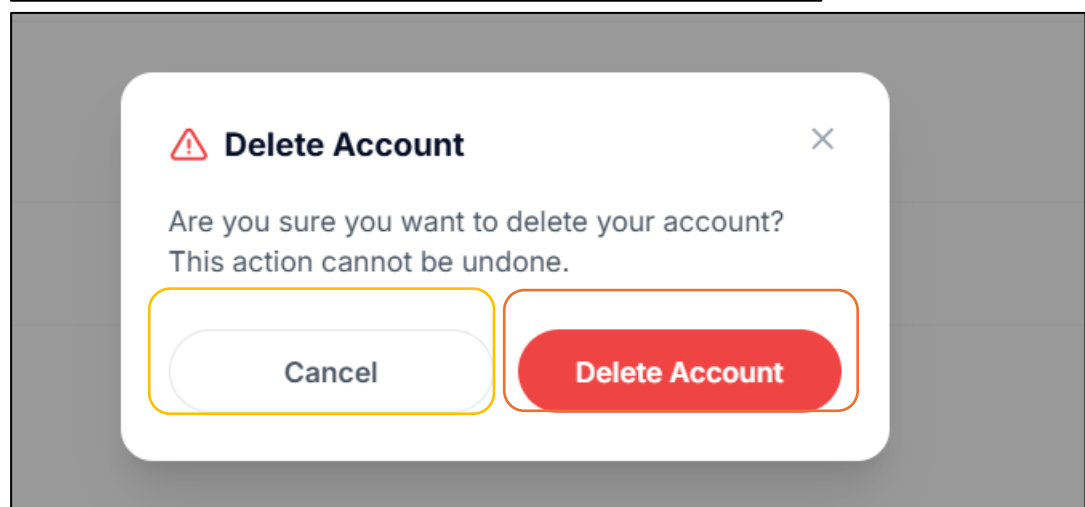
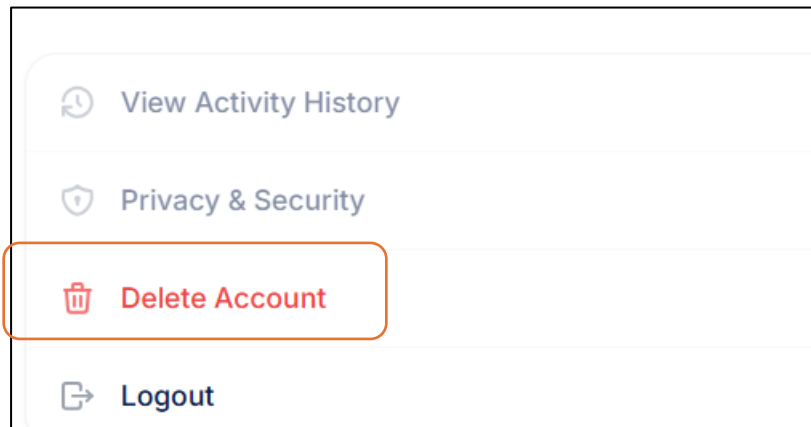


Deleting Your Account

You can delete your Unitrade account anytime and will be required to sign up from the beginning the next time you want to use the system.

1. Use the delete button from the profile page:

- Click “Delete Account” on the profile page to successfully delete your account.
- Once your account is deleted you have to go through the whole registration process again when you want to use the system again.



- If you change you mind about deleting your account, you can Press cancel, and your account will not be deleted.

5.Dashboards

Buyer's Side

The dashboard is where you can browse all listings, reserve and add to wish list.

1. Browse all listings.

This page displays all active listings available on UniTrade, giving you a place to explore what other students are selling. Listings are shown as cards with a preview image, title, price and category, this helps you to quickly scan through the options.

- **Filter By category**
 - Narrow down listings to a specific category (e.g. Textbooks, Electronics, Furniture, Clothing) so you only see items relevant to what you are looking for.
- **Filter by Condition**
 - Refine your search results based on each of the item's condition (e.g. Like New, Fair, Good, Worn) so you can quickly find listings that match your quality expectations.
- **Sort**
 - Reorder the listings bases on your preference, such as Newest First, Price: Low to High or Price: High to Low, making it easier for you to find the best deals or the most recently listed items.

UniTrade

MAIN

Browse Listings

Switch

My Orders

My Wishlist

My Reservations

ACCOUNT

Messages

Profile

TM

Tafadzwa Buyer

Search...

3

Browse All Listings

4 listings available at the University of Pretoria

All

Textbooks

Clothing

Electronics

Furniture

Stationery

Other

All conditions

Newest



Study Table

Furniture

R190

Reserve

Add to Wishlist

like_new



Dell 15 inch Laptop

Electronics

R7 500

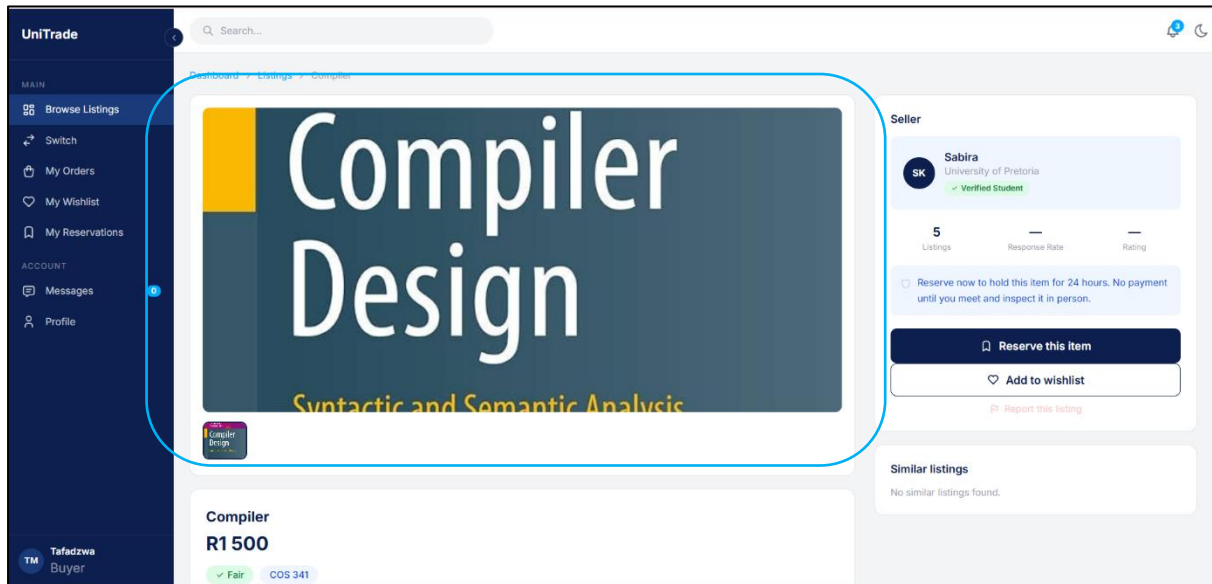
Reserve

Add to Wishlist

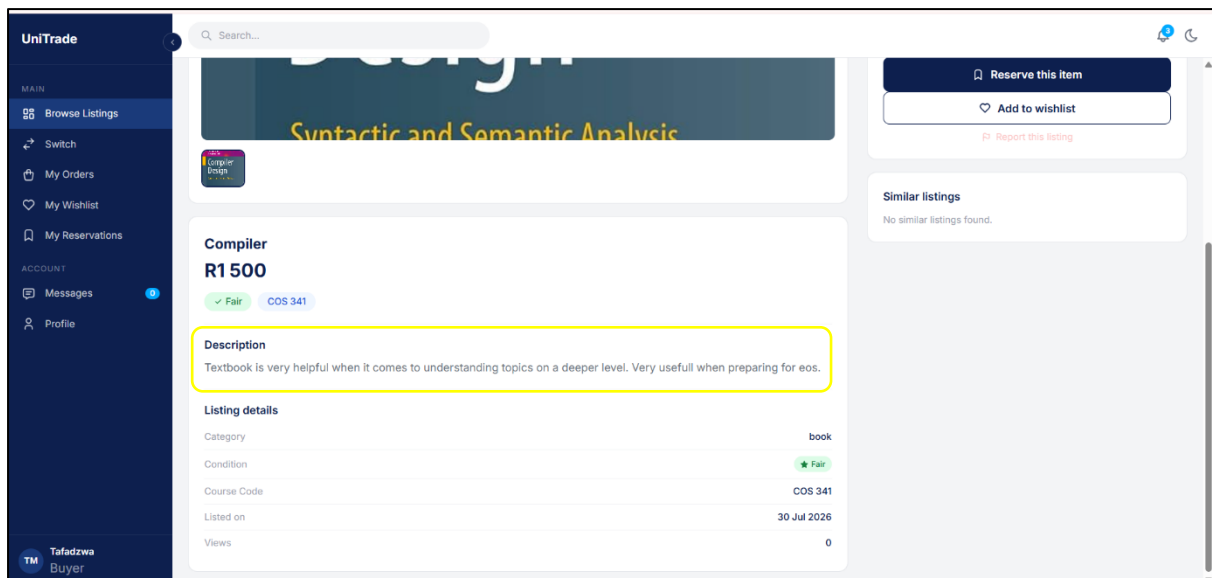
Good

View listing's details

- Clicking on any listing card takes you to its full details page, where you can see everything, you need to decide whether to make a reservation. This includes:
 - Full image gallery – Browse through all photos the seller has uploaded, not just the preview image.



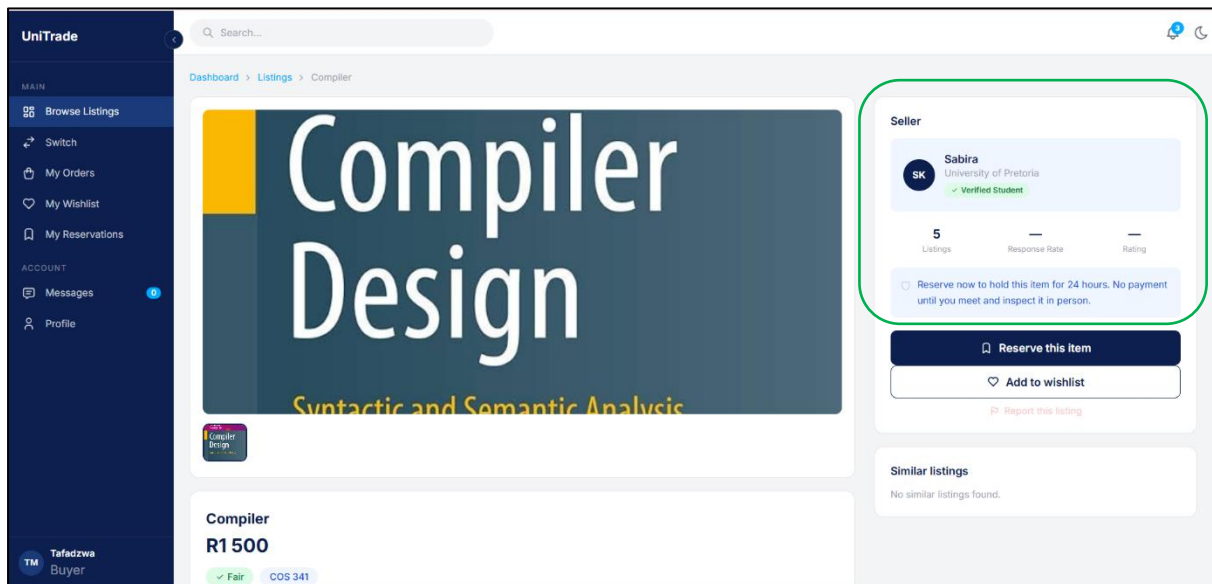
- Item description – A detailed write-up from the seller covering condition, specifications, and any other relevant information.



- Price – The listed price for the item.
- Category and condition – Confirming what type of item it is and its current state.

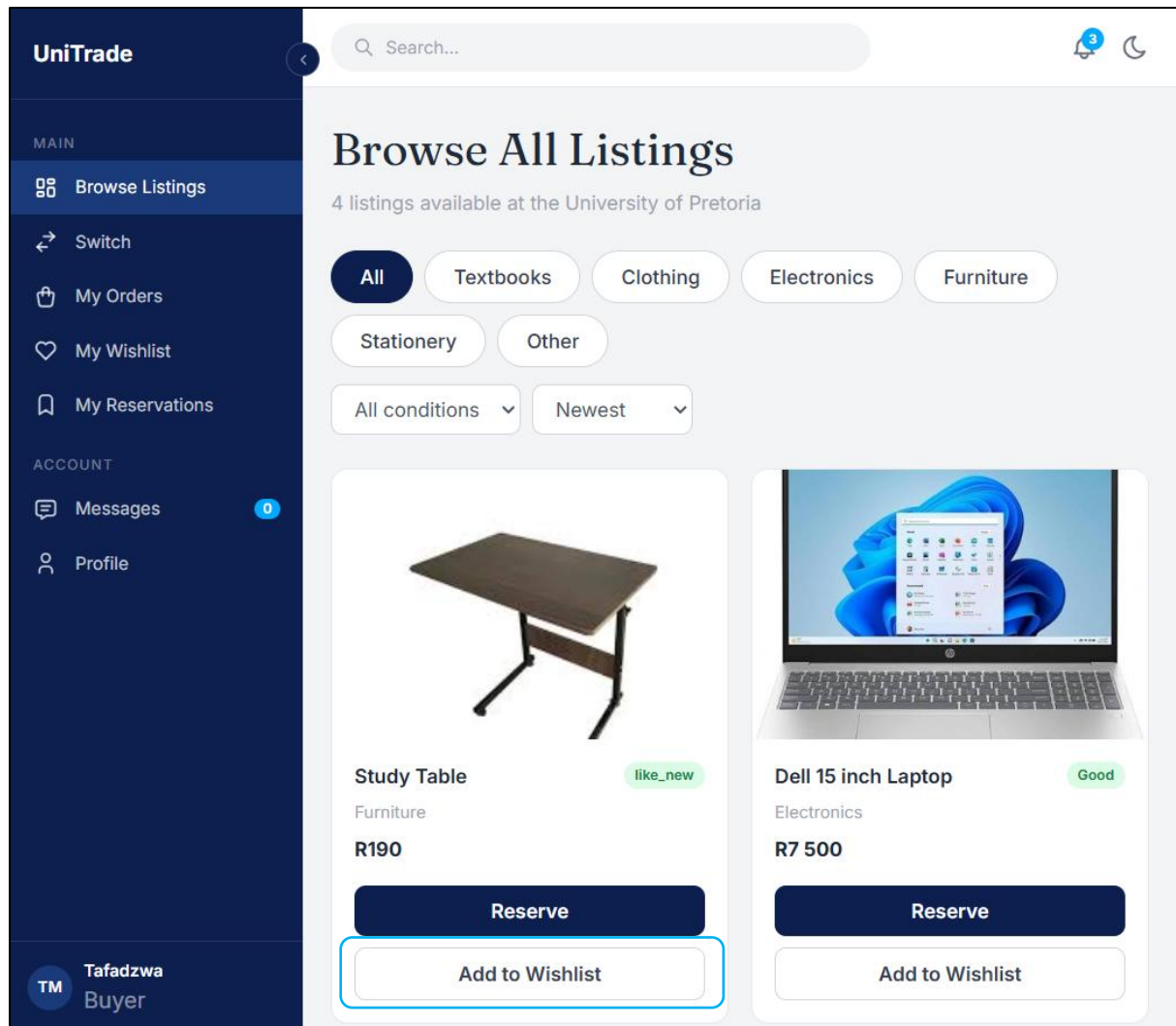


- Seller Information – Details about who is selling the item, so you know who you are dealing with.



Add To Wish List

- If you find an item you're interested in but aren't ready to reserve it yet, you can add it to your Wish List by clicking on the Wishlist button on the browse all listings page. The lets you:
 - Save listings you want to revisit later without losing track on them.
 - Keep a personalized collection of items you are considering.
 - Quickly access saved items from your Wishlist page instead of searching for them again.



- After adding to your Wishlist

UniTrade

MAIN

Browse Listings

Switch

My Orders

My Wishlist

My Reservations

ACCOUNT

Messages

Profile

TM

Tafadzwa Buyer

Search...

3

Browse All Listings

4 listings available at the University of Pretoria

All

Textbooks

Clothing

Electronics

Furniture

Stationery

Other

All conditions

Newest



Study Table

Furniture

R190

like_new

Reserve

In Wishlist



Dell 15 inch Laptop

Electronics

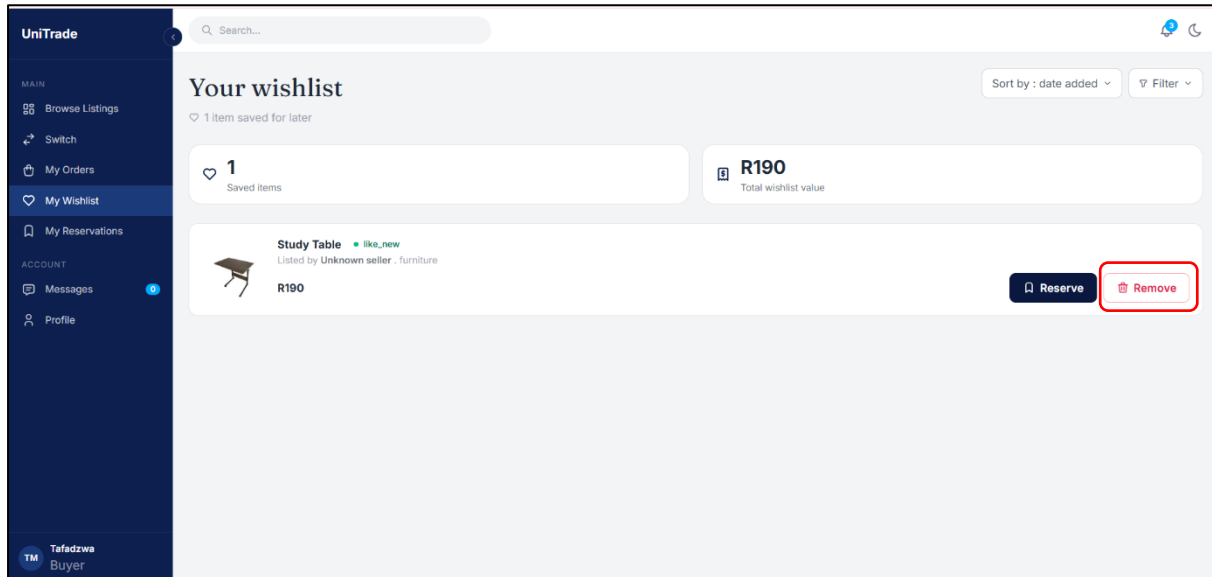
R7 500

Good

Reserve

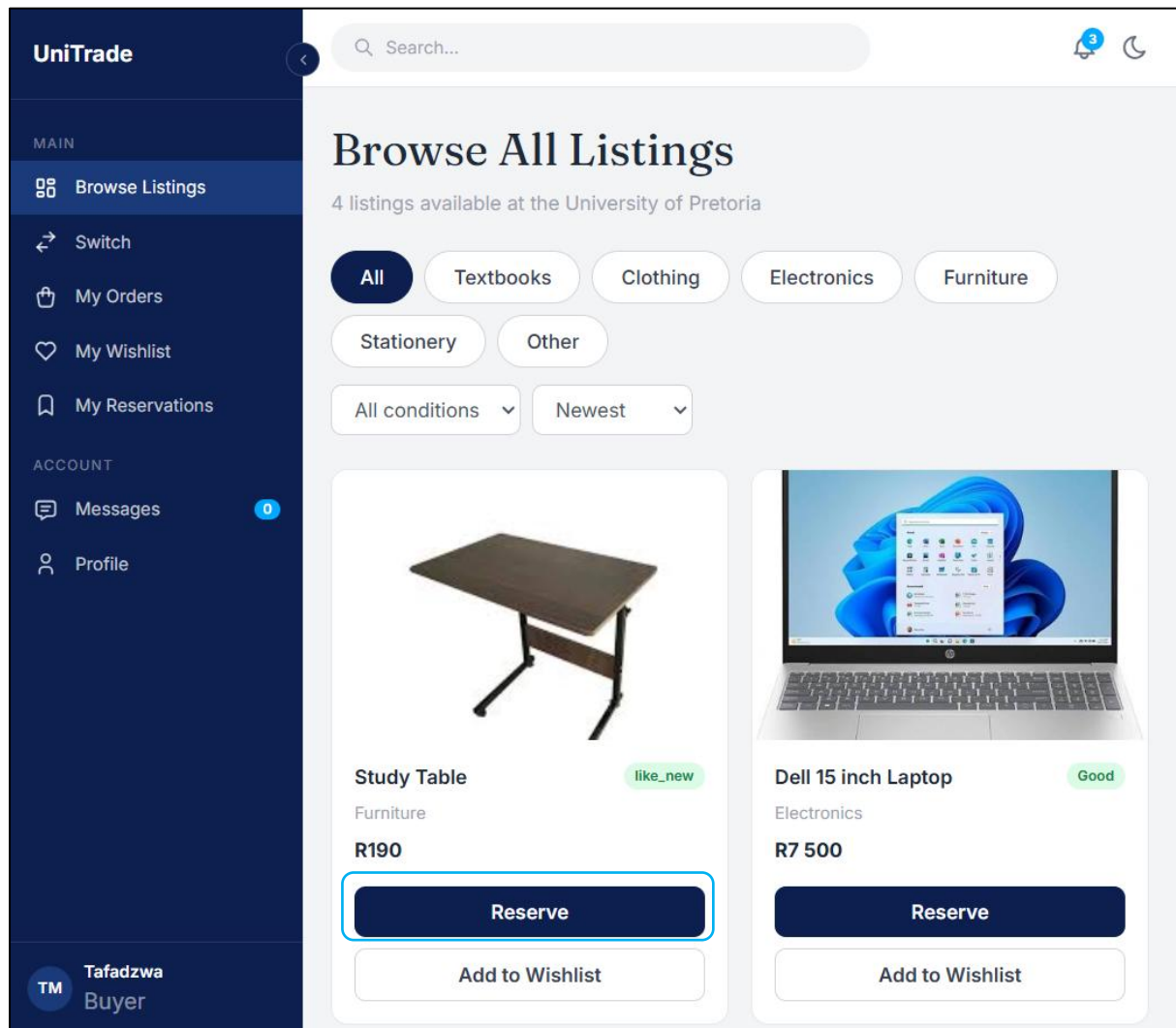
Add to Wishlist

- Your Wishlist page
- Remove from Wishlist
 - If you no longer want an item saved, you can remove it from your Wishlist by clicking the remove button on the Wishlist page. This helps in keeping Wishlist up to date and only showing items you're genuinely interested in.



2. Reserve

- Once you have decided on an item, you can reserve it directly from the listing's page by clicking the **Reserve** button. This action:
 - Notifies the seller that you are interested in their listing.
 - Prevents the item from being reserved by other buyers while your reservation is still active.
 - Creates a reservation record you can track from your Reservations page.

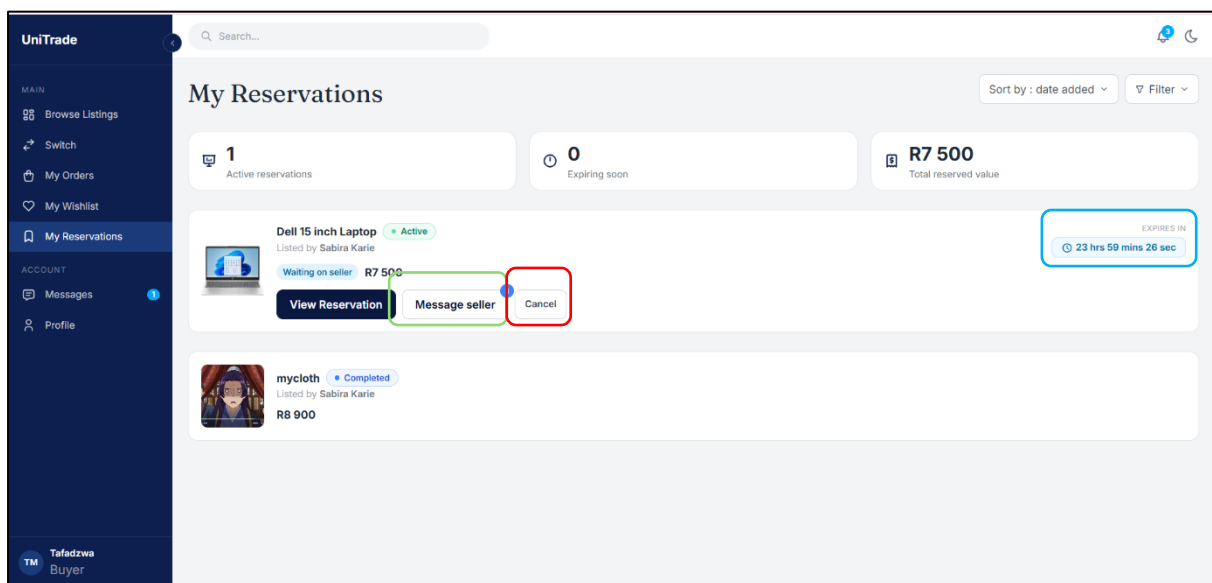


- View Reservations Details
 - From your reservations page, you can click into any active reservation to see its full details, including the item information, reservation status. This gives you a quick overview of where things stand without having to go back to the original listing.

The screenshot displays the UniTrade mobile application interface. On the left is a dark blue sidebar with navigation options: MAIN (Browse Listings, Switch, My Orders, My Wishlist, My Reservations) and ACCOUNT (Messages, Profile). The main content area shows the details of a reservation for a 'Dell 15 inch Laptop'. At the top right, a timer indicates 'Expires in 23 hrs 45 mins 57 sec'. The 'Item' section includes a laptop image, title, condition ('good'), category ('electronics'), price ('R 7 500'), and status ('Active'). The 'Seller' section identifies 'Sabira Karie' as a 'University of Pretoria student' with a rating of '-' and 5 total sales. The 'Actions' section at the bottom offers 'Message Seller' and 'Complete Payment' buttons. The 'Reservation Info' section on the right lists the reservation ID, date reserved (30 Jul 2026), expiry date (31 Jul 2026), and expiry time (23:52). The bottom of the screen shows the user is 'Tafadzwa Buyer'.

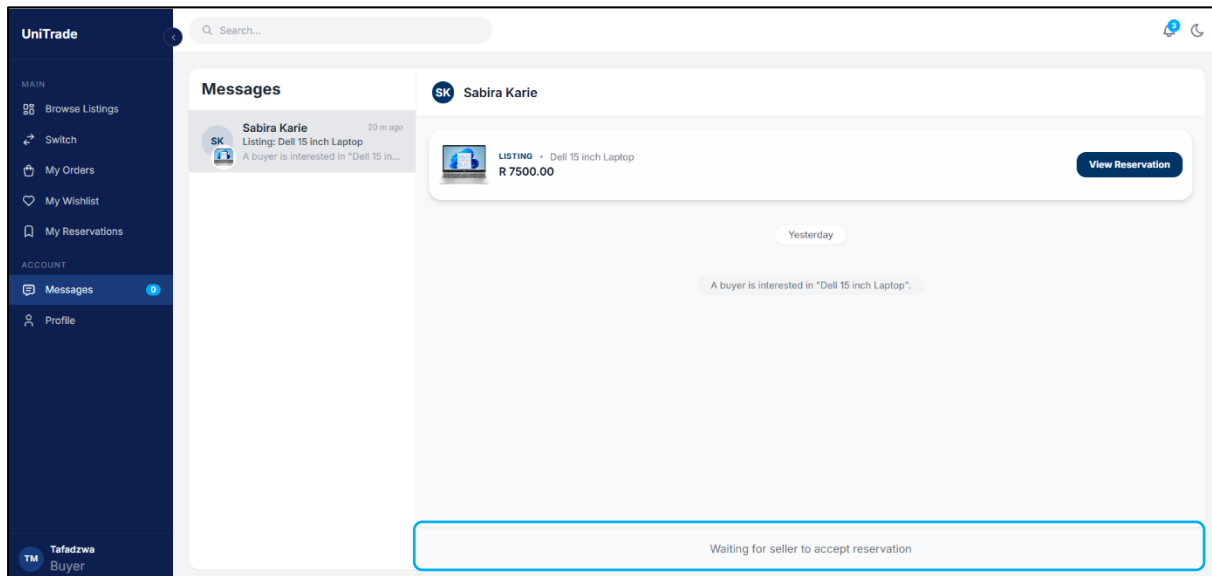
Reservation Info	
Reservation ID	#5c91d79c-f7e0-4f5f-a107-0edaab98e815
Date Reserved	30 Jul 2026
Expiry Date	31 Jul 2026
Expiry Time	23:52

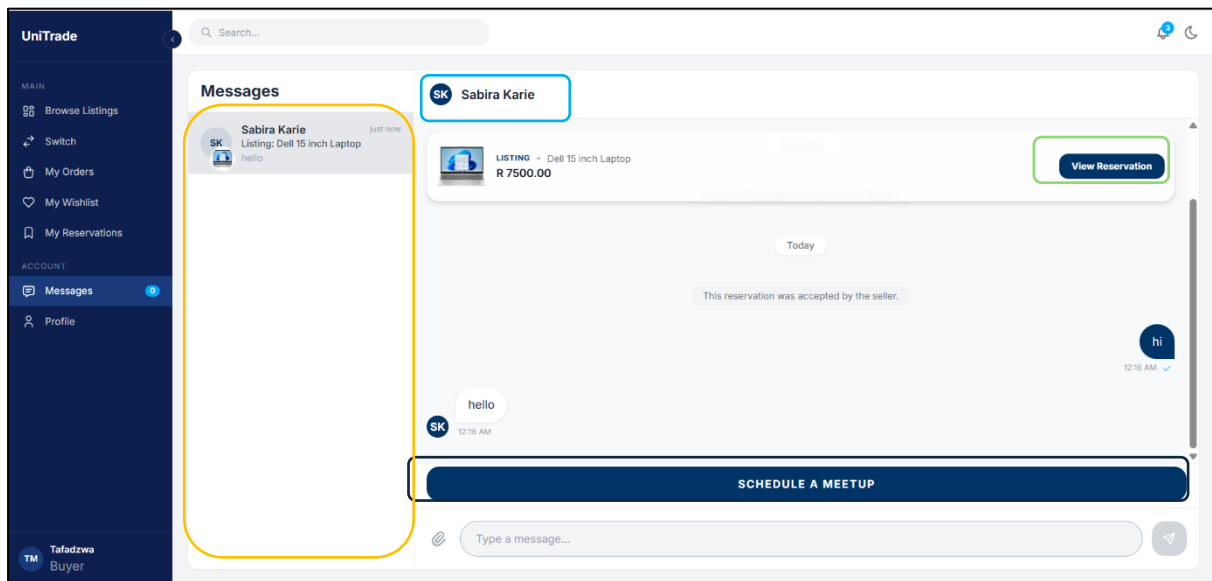
- After reserving your item will be held for you for 24 hours until you or the seller schedules a meeting, when the meeting is scheduled the timer will be stopped, but if the timer expires the listing will be put up for sale again, so ensure you schedule the meeting within the 24 hours.
- Message Seller
 - Directly from your reservation, you can open a chat with the seller to ask questions, confirm details, or arrange a meetup time and location. This keeps all communication tied to a specific reservation, so there is no confusion about which item you are discussing.
- Cancel Reservation
 - If you change your mind or can no longer go through with the purchase, you cancel the reservation by clicking the **Cancel** button on the reservation card.



3. Chat Page

- You can only start chatting with the seller once they have accepted the reservation.





- The seller's name and Initials.
- Use this button to view the reservation directly from the chat, instead of going back to the reservations page.
- Use the button to propose/schedule a meeting with the seller (this is particularly important and should be done).
- This is the chat sidebar where you see all the messages you received, this is also for quick access of the other chats.

- How to schedule a meetup
 - Click on the schedule meeting on the chat page and you will get a popup where you need to specify the following:
 - Your preferred date
 - Your preferred time
 - Your preferred location (you can use the map and pin your preferred location, this is can also be used by the other person if they do not have the directions to the meetup location, then can just use the map).

Propose a Meetup

DATE

2026/07/30

TIME

00:25

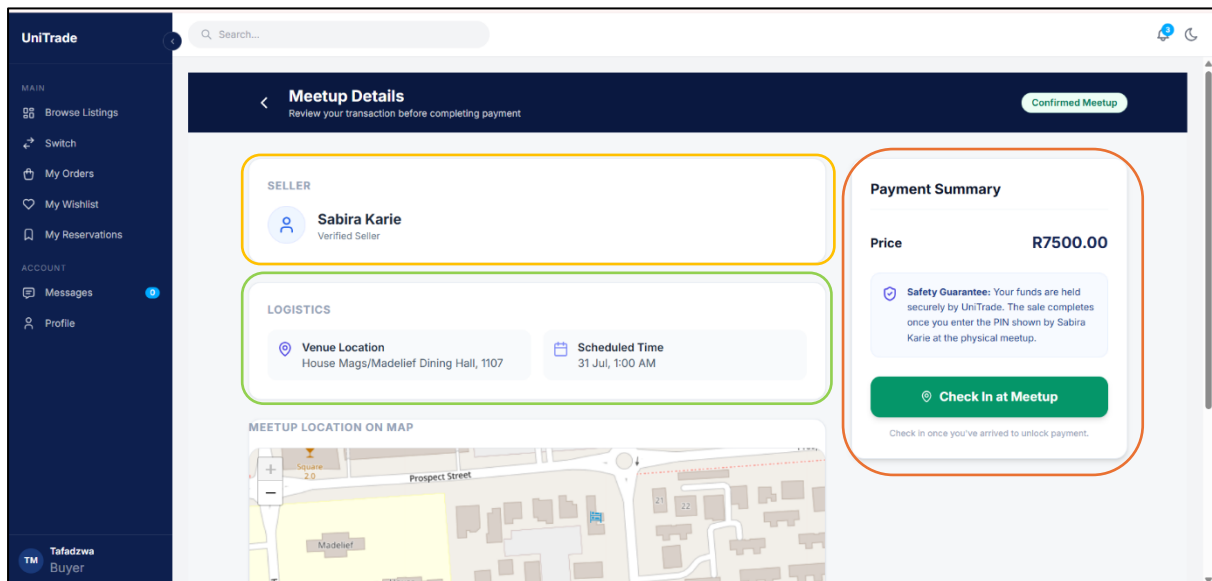
MEETUP LOCATION

e.g. Merensky Library - Main Entrance

Tap the map to drop a pin at the exact spot.

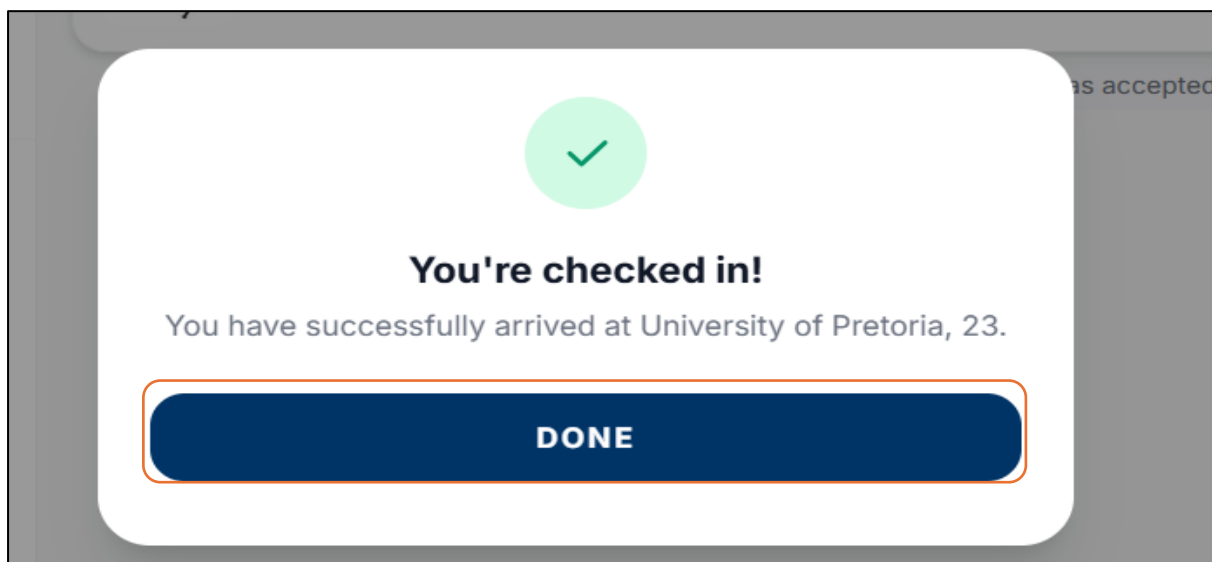
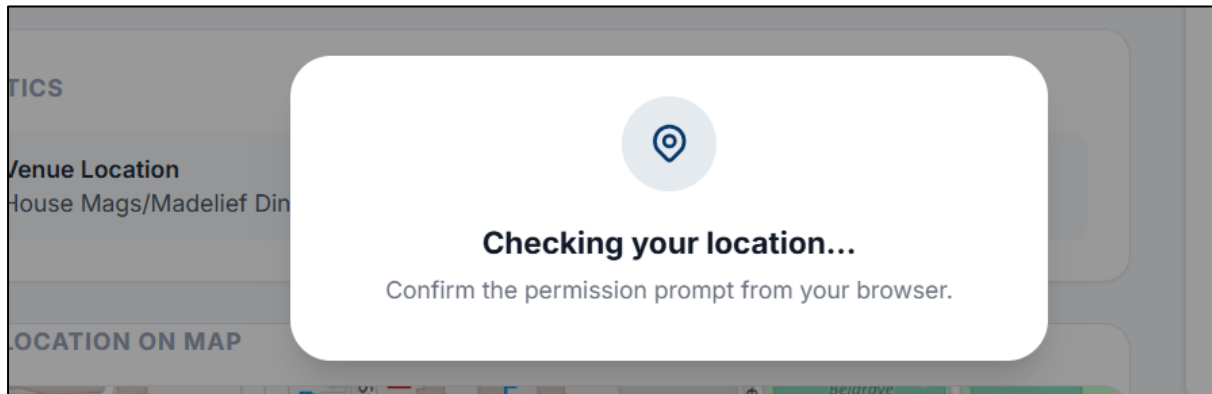
Map showing streets: Burnett Street, Prospect Street, South Street, Ring Road, Faculty Street, Lynnwood Road, Elandsport. A red dashed line outlines a central area. A blue pin is placed on the map.

- View Meetup Details



- Seller details, showing that they are actually verified hence allowed to use the system.
- Logistics, showing the venue location, scheduled date and time.
- Payment summary, showing the price of the product, safety guarantee and a check in button, the check in button is what you use when you get to the agreed location, if you don't check in upon arrival you won't be allowed to pay, because the payment button is only shown once you've checked in.

- Checking in
 - Allow the browser access to your location and you will be allowed to check in, once checked in, you will be allowed to pay.
 - Press Done after checking in and you will be allowed to proceed to payment.



4. Payment

- Press **Pay** and you will be redirected to Pay Fast to process your payment.

Payment Summary

Price**R190.00**

 **Safety Guarantee:** Your funds are held securely by UniTrade. The sale completes once you enter the PIN shown by Seller at the physical meetup.

 **Pay R190.00**

By paying you agree to the UniTrade Payment policies.

Secured and powered by 

 You're in the sandbox. This is a **testing environment** used to ensure correct integration with PayFast. If unexpected, please contact the merchant you are trying to pay to resolve the matter.

Study Table

Payment total:	R 190.00
----------------	----------

Wallet funds

You have a balance of R 103,108,249.42

Complete Payment

From balance -R 190.00
Remaining balance R 103,108,059.42

Cancel transaction

- Press **Complete Payment**, to complete the payment.
- Use the **cancel transaction** if you cannot pay or change your mind.
- The payment summary that shows you the total amount you must pay.

- If the payment was complete, you will get the confirmation below on Pay Fast



You're in the sandbox. This is a **testing environment** used to ensure correct integration with PayFast. If unexpected, please contact the merchant you are trying to pay to resolve the matter.

Study Table

Subtotal:	R 190.00
Wallet funds:	- R 190.00
Payment total:	R 0.00



Your payment was successful!

We have sent a receipt of your payment to sbtu01@payfast.co.za

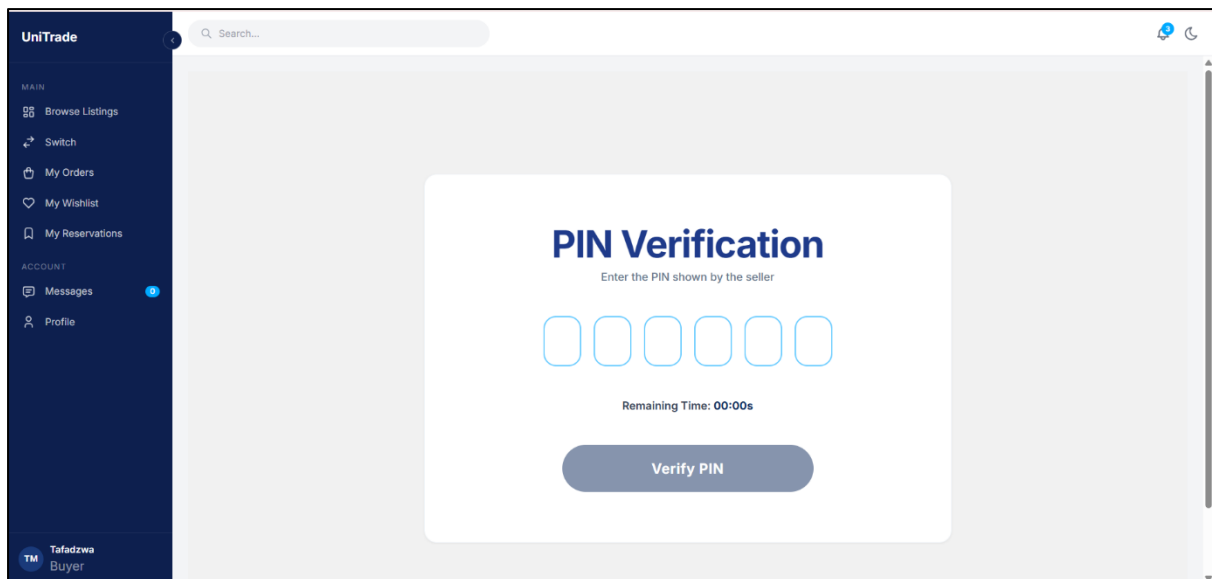
You will be redirected back to the merchant shortly

[Back to](#)

- You receipt that you can show the seller, as proof of payment if they ever want to see it.

5. After Payment

- After completing the payment, you must receive and enter the PIN that the seller gives you. This PIN is used as the final confirmation of the transaction, if you don't enter the PIN the transaction will never be marked as complete, so the PIN confirmation is important.



The screenshot shows the UniTrade application interface. On the left is a dark blue sidebar with the UniTrade logo at the top. Below the logo, there are two sections: 'MAIN' with links for 'Browse Listings', 'Switch', 'My Orders', 'My Wishlist', and 'My Reservations'; and 'ACCOUNT' with links for 'Messages' and 'Profile'. At the bottom of the sidebar is a 'Tafadzwa Buyer' badge. The main content area is light gray and features a central white card titled 'PIN Verification'. Below the title, it says 'Enter the PIN shown by the seller'. There are six empty square boxes for entering the PIN. Below these boxes, it says 'Remaining Time: 00:00s'. At the bottom of the card is a blue button labeled 'Verify PIN'. The top of the screen has a search bar and a notification icon.

Seller's Side

1. My Listings Page

- Click New Listing to upload a new listing.
- Filter by Status.
- Click view to view the listings details, this is where you get more details on your listing.
- If you don't want to sell your product anymore, you are allowed to delete the listing, only when it is in the live, draft stage, once your listing has been reserved you are blocked from deleting it, because that will not be fair to the buyer.
- If you want to change some details about the listing, e.g. the price, condition or description, click the edit button and you will be taken to the Edit Listing page.

UniTrade

Search...

My Listings

Manage all Listings in one place

+ New Listing

8 Total Listings

0 Live

0 Pending Review

0 Drafts

All Live (0) Pending (0) Drafts (0) Rejected (0) Sold (3)

LISTING	PRICE	STATUS	VIEWS	ACTIONS
dfghji clothing - Listed 31 Jul 2026	R56	Reserved	0	View Edit Delete
Study Table furniture - Listed 30 Jul 2026	R190	Reserved	0	View Edit Delete
Dell 15 inch Laptop electronics - Listed 30 Jul 2026	R7 500	Reserved	0	View Edit Delete
H&M Sweater clothing - Listed 30 Jul 2026	R249	Reserved	0	View Edit Delete

SK Sabira Karie Seller

2. Upload Listing

- Follow these steps to successfully upload a new listing.
 - Choose the correct category of your listing, this is mandatory and should be done honestly because it will be used for recommending products to buyers.
 - Write a Title for your product, if your product is a textbook, you can print the name of that textbook.
 - Write a detailed description of the listing, e.g. what edition of the textbook is it, or what brand of laptop it is.
 - Upload the images of your listing, do not use images from the internet as that is not your own images, if it is caught that you used internet images, you may be flagged or even banned from using the system. Consider uploading at least 2 images.

UniTrade

Search...

Create New Listing

Fill in the details below to list your item.

Step 1: Basic Information

Listing Information

Category: **Textbooks** Clothing Electronics Furniture Stationery Other

Title: Module (e.g. COS110):

Description:

Step 2: Pictures

Images (Drag & Drop or Upload)

Up to 8 photos, max 10MB each

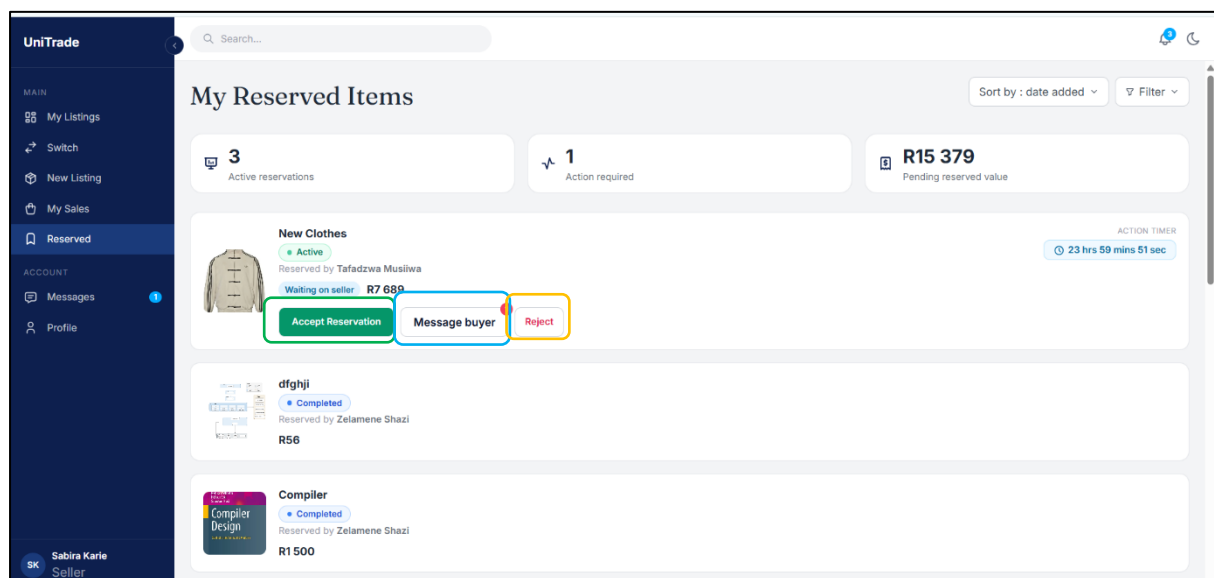
Sabira Karie Seller

- Specify the price of your listing.
- Pick the condition of your product, it is very important that you are honest about this part because it can be misleading to the buyer if you lie about the condition of your product.
- After entering all the required details, you will get confirmation with a summary view of your listing, if this is not correct to what you had in mind, please check the details you entered and correct and wrong information.
- After confirming that everything is correct, and you are ready to submit listing click Submit Listing and the listing will go live.
- If you are not ready for your listing to go live, you can save the listing as draft and you can always submit it when you are ready.

The screenshot displays the UniTrade 'New Listing' interface. On the left is a dark blue sidebar with navigation links: 'My Listings', 'Switch', 'New Listing' (highlighted), 'My Sales', 'Reserved', 'Messages', and 'Profile'. The main content area shows a progress bar with 'Step 3: Price' (checked) and 'Step 4: Confirmation' (active). Below the progress bar, the 'Pricing' section includes a 'Price (ZAR)' input field with 'R' entered and a 'Condition' section with buttons for 'Like New', 'Good', 'Fair', and 'Worn'. The 'Summary Overview' section shows a preview of the listing titled 'Untitled Listing' with the category 'Book - RG - Like New'. At the bottom right are two buttons: 'Save Draft' and 'Submit Listing'.

3. Reservation

- After the buyer reserves your product, it will appear in your “My Reserved” page, and you are supposed to accept the buyer’s reservation within 24 hours to ensure that the reservation does not expire.
- If the buyer is silent after 12 hours of reserving your product you as the seller has the right to cancel that reservation, hence you can’t cancel the reservation before the 12-hour mark.
- To chat with the buyer, click “Message buyer”, and coordinate a meetup place with them, either you or the buyer has to schedule the meeting.
- You are also allowed to reject the buyer’s reservation if you have other plans for your listing.



Payment

- After the buyer completes their payment, and you have received the funds, you will have a generate PIN button, you should give the buyer this pin so they can enter it on their side, this is the final step of the payment.

Payment Summary

Price **R7689.00**

 **Safety Guarantee:** Show your PIN to Tafadzwa Musiiwa at the physical meetup. The sale completes once they enter it.

 **Show PIN to Buyer**

Transaction PIN

Show this PIN to the buyer. They enter it to complete the sale.

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9

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Waiting for the buyer to enter this PIN...